

Mobile HD link switch

ON Semiconductor has come up with a 3:1 high-speed USB switch that supports the new Mobile High Definition Link (MHLTM) interface standard for high-definition (HD) video and digital audio.

Through its integrated MHLTM support, the NCN1188 enables smartphones and other portable consumer electronics to connect with HD televisions for high-speed content sharing. Two dedicated high-speed data paths can handle HD video transfer up to 720 progressive scan at 60 frames per second (fps) and 1080 interlaced at 30 fps. A multi-purpose audio path, with true-ground capability down to -2V, supporting generic micro-USB headsets, is also included, making this the first audio-capable MHLTM switch to enter the market.

World's first multi-mode data card

The world's first LTE TDD/UMTS/GSM/CDMA multi-mode data card will soon be available to LTE TDD network operators worldwide.

The Huawei E392 is a USB data



Huawei E392

card that incorporates LTE TDD technology while remaining compatible with UMTS/GSM/CDMA networks, automatically switching between different networks to ensure optimal Internet connectivity.

The download speed of E392 is up to 100M, making it possible to download a 4GB HD movie file in a few minutes. This is 20 times faster than the data transmission speed of the existing 3G network, providing ultra-speed Internet surfing, high-definition video download-

ing and online viewing, video transmission and real-time 3D photo navigation.

3TB SATA hard drives for AV platforms

Western Digital (WD) has added 2.5TB and 3TB versions to its family of AV-GP SATA hard drives serving the audio-video (AV) market. The new 8.9cm (3.5-inch) drives offer 24x7 reliability, low power consumption and large storage capacity for storage-intensive AV applications such as digital video recorders, video surveillance, single-drive media servers and external multimedia storage.

The drives combine power-saving GreenPower technology and performance capabilities to capture up to twelve simultaneous HD video streams with Silk-Stream technology. These are field-tested to have a 1.0M hour MTBF rating.

Intelligent power manager

Eaton's Intelligent Power manager software is said to be the first in the industry to integrate with XenCenter virtualisation architecture. Users of XenCenter can monitor and manage their power and network devices from the same system dashboard, reducing infrastructure and operating costs while increasing productivity and operational responsiveness.

In addition to monitoring and managing power equipment across the enterprise, customers can view critical power information such as the status of uninterruptible power systems (UPS), power distribution units (ePDU products) and environmental sensors from the central XenCenter screen. As part of this integration, when a physical host server experiences a prolonged power interruption, XenCenter's XenMotion application will transparently move virtual machines from the affected server to an available server on the network, ensuring data integrity and zero downtime.

India to develop solar-powered UAVs

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) of India plans

to develop solar-powered unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) with long-range and high endurance capability. These UAVs will have the capability to remain airborne for at least a month irrespective of the weather conditions.

The vehicles will have specially-designed solar panels to keep them airborne in all weather conditions such as in nights and cloudy weather with the help of power generated and saved during the day. Special attention would be paid to keep their frame light but strong enough to endure different weather conditions.

The vehicles would be capable of providing real-time information and data of the area through a secure data link. These will also carry a variety of cameras that can look deep into the enemy territory for surveillance and reconnaissance purposes.

Solar-powered crop-harvesting robot

A solar-powered crop-harvesting robot developed by T.J. David and Kudikala Shruvan Kumar from International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad, has won the Intel India Embedded Challenge 2011. This nationwide competition is an initiative by Intel in India to recognise and reward outstanding ideas in embedded technology, based on the Intel Atom processor.

The energy-efficient, lightweight robot overcomes drawbacks of prior arts of conventional harvesting machines. It requires only 500W of electric energy stored in batteries, which can be charged by solar PV panels or grid power. The cost of harvesting one acre of land is Rs 10 if grid power (at Rs 5 per kW) is used for charging the batteries, while a conventional harvester consumes diesel worth Rs 800.

The machine weighs about 125 kg. It is operable both via remote and electrically, and requires an embedded system and control to operate. The overall cost of the reaping system is Rs 50,000. It can be adapted for cutting various crops apart from paddy and wheat by changing the cutter bar.

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